

Trump’s plan for peace in Gaza

The president and Netanyahu demand Hamas disarm, step down, free hostages.

By NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — President Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Monday put forth a 20-point plan to end the war in the Gaza Strip, a sweeping proposal that calls on Hamas to not only lay down its arms but to give up any role in governing the enclave.

Key elements of the plan, which the leaders announced at the White House in Washington, include the release of hostages, a prisoner swap involving hundreds and amnesty for Hamas fighters. Trump would play a role, heading a commission created to govern Gaza.

Trump said he was “very, very close” to a deal to end the war, though it had yet to receive any reaction from Hamas. The plan calls for the Israeli military to cease fighting once the pact is approved, but does not specify a final pullout of forces from Gaza.

“And I think we’re beyond very close,” added Trump of his most concerted push yet to reach a ceasefire between Israel and Hamas, even as the Israeli military presses with its offensive into Gaza City, the enclave’s largest urban center.

In a 30-minute speech to reporters following his meeting with Netanyahu, Trump appeared enthusiastic about his proposal, touting it as an unprecedented step toward peace not only in Gaza but also across the Middle East. “This is potentially one of the greatest days ever in civilization,” he said.

Trump said that he was “hearing that Hamas wants to get this done too.” But, he added, if Hamas didn’t agree to the plan, Israel would have the “right” and “full

[See Gaza, A4]

Inquiry looks into ‘cult-like’ group

Police investigate Hemet organization’s ties to dead boy and two missing members.

By CLARA HARTER AND RICHARD WINTON

The ambulance siren blared down the quiet residential street where a 4-year-old boy was dying.

When police and paramedics arrived at 1521 Latham St. in Colton, they had no clue they were entering the home of a secretive religious group that — years later — would land in the spotlight after two members were reported missing.

Inside the house, police found Timothy Thomas unresponsive with vomit around his mouth, according to an investigative report from the San Bernardino County Sheriff’s Department’s Coroner Division.

The boy, according to Colton Police Sgt. Shawn McFarland, was in the temporary custody of Darryl Muzic Martin and his wife, Shelly Bailey “Kathryn” Martin — leaders of a religious group called His Way Spirit Led Assemblies.

Timothy died on Jan. 16, 2010 — within an hour of the 911 call, according to the coroner’s report.

[See Inquiry, A6]



ALEX BRANDON Associated Press

CONGRESSIONAL leaders, including House Speaker Mike Johnson, center, met with President Trump.

KIMMEL SAGA SHOWS RISKS FOR DISNEY’S NEXT CHIEF

Fallout from the Burbank giant’s handling of late-night controversy complicates the search for Iger’s successor

By Meg James



CHRIS PIZZELLO Associated Press

BOB IGER is set to step down as chief executive of Walt Disney Co. in late 2026.

A 10-second bit by ABC comedian Jimmy Kimmel plunged Walt Disney Co. into a full-blown crisis that rippled across America.

President Trump, the Federal Communications Commission chief and others were angered this month over Kimmel’s remarks about the Charlie Kirk shooting, which they said had suggested the suspect was a “Make America Great Again” Republican. Kimmel asserted Trump supporters were “trying to score political points” from the tragedy.

TV station groups pulled the program and Disney benched the comedian, sparking a bigger backlash. Protesters lit into the Mouse House for seemingly kowtowing to the Trump administration, consumers canceled Disney+ and Hulu subscriptions and more than 400 celebrities, including Tom Hanks, Jamie Lee Curtis and Lin-Manuel Miranda, signed a letter calling for a defense of free speech. Some investors bailed, briefly erasing nearly \$4 billion in corporate market value.

Disney Chief Executive Bob Iger and his team turned the tide last week when they returned Kimmel to his late-night perch.

But the pressure on Disney’s top brass remains. Trump was not happy over Kimmel’s comeback, grouching that he may lob another lawsuit at ABC. In December, Disney agreed to pay \$15 million to end a defamation suit Trump brought against the network and anchor George Stephanopoulos over misstatements.

And FCC Chairman Brendan Carr — who threatened ABC over Kimmel’s comments — isn’t backing down; he’s already opened one investigation into Disney and ABC for their diversity embrace.

“This [situation] isn’t going away anytime soon,” Nien-hé Hsieh, a Harvard Business School professor, said in an interview. “How it is managed certainly matters a lot.”

The Kimmel controversy exposed cracks at the Burbank [See Disney, A14]

\$55-billion deal struck for video game maker

Electronic Arts is being taken private as the industry struggles with a slowdown.

By WENDY LEE

Redwood City, Calif.-based Electronic Arts Inc., the maker of “Madden NFL” and “The Sims,” is set to be acquired for about \$55 billion, in the latest example of change amid a slowdown in the video gaming industry.

The massive deal, which would be the biggest leveraged buyout in history, is backed by Saudia Arabia’s Public Investment Fund, as well as private equity firms Silver Lake and Affinity Partners. It is expected to close next year, pending shareholder and regulatory approvals. Affinity Partners is run by President Trump’s son-in-law Jared Kushner.

The Monday announcement comes as the video gaming industry is undergoing consolidation and is facing increased competition

as it struggles to return to the high growth rates it saw during the COVID-19 pandemic.

“Together with our partners, we will create transformative experiences to inspire generations to come,” said Andrew Wilson, EA’s chairman and CEO, in a statement. “I am more energized than ever about the future we are building.”

EA stockholders will receive \$210 per share in cash, a 25% premium over the stock’s closing price of \$168.32 per share on Thurs-

day. The company’s shares had climbed about 15%, in line with the Nasdaq composite index, from January to the middle of last week before the news of the acquisition plans came out.

After the deal is completed, the company will be taken private.

Wilson, who has been CEO since 2013, will remain in his position and EA’s headquarters will continue to be in Redwood City.

The video game industry received a boost during the COVID-19 pandemic as peo-

ple looked for ways to entertain themselves at home. But since then, many companies have undergone cuts as they adjust to increased production costs and the concentration of demand on a smaller number of megahit, live-play games.

While video games remain popular, and some franchises are seeing success in their transition to film or series, EA’s annual revenues have been stagnant over the last three fiscal years, fluctuating between [See Game maker, A10]

How Medicaid cuts threaten a family’s lifeline

By TYRONE BEASON

Ever since Elijah Maldonado was born at just 29 weeks, he has needed specialty treatments that his family could afford only with publicly funded health-care.

Diagnosed with cerebral palsy as an infant, he spent his first three months at a public hospital in Orange County, where the family lives.

Now 7, Elijah receives physical and speech therapy among a host of other serv-

ices paid for through Medicaid. He relies on a wheelchair funded by the government. An assistant paid for with taxpayer dollars makes sure he’s safe on the bus ride to and from school.

Each month, he receives a \$957 disability check that helps to cover his and his family’s living expenses.

Still learning to speak on his own, he uses a Proloquo speech app on an iPad provided by his school to tell his family when he’s hungry, needs to use the restroom or wants to play with his favorite toys.

“It’s his voice — his lifeline,” his aunt and primary caretaker Cassandra Gonzalez says of the app. Her compensation for his in-home care comes from taxpayer dollars too.

Now that lifeline — and much of the government assistance Elijah receives — is at risk of going away.

With hundreds of billions of dollars’ worth of cuts to Medicaid and food aid kicking in this fall thanks to the passage of the Republican-backed “One Big Beautiful Bill Act” — on top of earlier [See Medicaid, A7]



JULIANA YAMADA Los Angeles Times

CASSANDRA Gonzalez carries her nephew Elijah Maldonado, who is diagnosed with cerebral palsy.

Trump revives film tariff threat

Movies made outside the U.S. should be subject to tax penalty, he writes. **BUSINESS, A9**

Lakers, Clippers face the media

LeBron James says “maybe” on retirement; Kawhi Leonard denies wrongdoing. **SPORTS, B10**

McCartney plays an intimate show

Rocker charms a few thousand fans, and his wife, in Santa Barbara. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Turning sunny. L.A. Basin: 78/63. **B6**

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